

But What About Songs With Long Titles?!

Since the ID3v1 tags had only a 30 character space for song titles, album, artist and comments, song names like *Sending Postcards From a Plane Crash* were simply shortened. Long album and artist names were also similarly shortened. In addition to this, since the genre query was accessed from a pre-defined list of only 80 genres, some genres like *Baroque*, etc. could not be added. So the world waited till eventually, someone came along with a solution.

11.1.2 ID3v2

Incidentally, though both versions of the tag begin with ID3, ID3v2 has hardly any relationship with ID3v1. ID3v2 was designed with the aim of removing the restrictions that the ID3v1 tags had, and also, to add more information to the MP3 file. An ID3v2 tag allows users to add, apart from the regular ID3v1 tag information, lyrics, pictures, Web content, etc. to the MP3 file. But that is not the only difference between the two versions of ID3 tags.

ID3v2 tags store information in what are called frames. Every small portion of information in an ID3v2 tag is stored in different frames; so the artist name, album name, lyrics of the song, artist picture, etc. are stored in separate frame. As opposed to the limited amount of content in an ID3v1 tag, each frame in an ID3v2 tag can have a maximum size of 16 MB! The entire tag can have a size of up to 256 MB! Also, whereas an ID3v1 tag is placed at the end of an MP3 file, an ID3v2 tag is placed at the beginning. This is particularly useful when it comes to streaming MP3s on the Internet, as this bit of information is read immediately, allowing the listener to know details of the song before he/she hears it. Though there are some standard frames, like artist, lyrics, URL, etc. some media players allow you to add your own bits of information about the song as well. In addition, the ID3v2 tags can be linked to music databases like CDDb (more on CDDb later in this chapter) to get information automatically from the Internet.

There are three currently versions of ID3v2 tags—ID3v2.2, v2.3 and v2.4.